

Students explain why plants need light to make food.

Audience: student

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Think about a plant whose leaves have been covered so that no light reaches them. That plant cannot make its own food while the cover stays on. Light is required for a plant to make food.

explain

Plants make their own food in their leaves. Inside a leaf, water from the roots and carbon dioxide from the air are combined using energy from sunlight. This process is called photosynthesis. The result is sugar, which the plant uses as food to grow and stay healthy. Without light, a plant cannot make this sugar, so light is essential for a plant to feed itself.

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